



What Is Agentic AI?

AVC 248 • Design Self-Promotion • Week 2

“A chatbot answers. An agent gets the job done.”

THE BIG IDEA

Chatbot vs. agent

You already know chatbots. An agent is the next step: same kind of AI, but pointed at a job and set loose to do real work for you.



A chatbot

Waits for you. You ask a question, it answers, then it stops. Nothing happens until you type again.



An agent

Is given a job, instructions, and often a schedule. It goes and works on its own: searching, gathering, drafting.

Same AI, new job. An agent does work for you, not just with you.

HOW IT WORKS

What an agent actually does

Give it a goal once. Then, on its own and on a schedule, it runs the same simple loop every time it fires.



Searches

Scans the sources you chose for anything new.



Gathers

Pulls the relevant results together in one place.



Drafts

Writes up a summary, a list, or a first draft for you.



Repeats

Runs again every morning, so it is always current.

Set it once. It keeps working while you do other things.

An agent is three simple parts

It is not magic and it is not code you have to write. An agent is really just three plain ingredients you can read and edit yourself.



Instructions

A plain .md file: a clear description of the job, in your own words.



A profile

Who it is working for and what matters to you, so the work fits.



A schedule

When it runs, like every morning, so it works without being asked.

It is just a .md file. Instructions + profile + schedule. That is the whole agent.

IN THIS CLASS

Agents students actually built

These are real agents from AVC 248. Each one is a single instructions file aimed at one person's goal.



Find Your Flow Jillian

Surfaces calm, in-the-zone design work and routines that protect her focus.



Soar Jasper

Hunts motion and 3D openings and nudges him toward bolder portfolio moves.



Focus Kevin

Cuts the noise and points him at the few tasks that move his search forward.



Daily Job Hunt A shared example

Runs every morning, gathers fresh postings, and drafts a short shortlist.

One person, one goal, one instructions file. That is the pattern.

WHERE YOU BEGIN

Start with a practice agent

You do not build your real agent first. You start small, with a throwaway practice agent, just to get the feel of it.



Low stakes

It does not matter if it is rough. You are learning the moves, not shipping.



Feel the loop

See how instructions turn into action, and how small wording changes the output.



Build confidence

Once the practice agent clicks, building your own real one feels easy.

Practice first. The training wheels come off fast.

You keep tweaking it

An agent is rarely perfect on the first run. The skill is reading what it gave you, then editing the instructions a little before the next run.



Run it

Let the agent do its job once with the current instructions.



Read the result

Notice what missed, what is noise, and what you wish it caught.



Edit the .md

Sharpen the wording, then run again. Repeat until it is dialed in.

Tweak every run. A dialed-in agent is one you refined, not one you got right the first time.

WHY IT MATTERS

An agent works while you don't

The whole point: the busywork of a job search runs in the background, so your time goes to the creative, human parts.



Runs every morning

before you even open your laptop.



Less time lost to manual searching and sorting.



You always know where your search stands.



More hours for the design work only you can do.

You stay the designer. The agent handles the grind.



Next, you will build your own agent.

“Start with practice. Tweak until it’s yours.”